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CONFLICTS OF INTEREST IN THE PROMOTION PROCESS: A REFLECTION BASED ON EXPERIENCE.

Conflicts of interest in the workplace represent one of the main challenges to organizational ethics and transparency. Although they are often addressed from a normative or theoretical perspective, their impact is best understood by analyzing specific situations experienced within companies. The following essay presents a reflection based on direct experience with a promotion process, which demonstrates how a conflict of interest can affect trust, fairness, and the organizational climate.

In the context of a company in the service sector, an internal promotion process was conducted to fill a supervisory position. This process was presented as an opportunity based on merit, career trajectory, and the candidates' performance. Several employees met the established requirements and participated with the expectation of an objective and transparent evaluation. Responsibility for the process fell to the department head, who was tasked with reviewing the profiles and issuing the final recommendation.

During the process, a problematic situation arose: one of the candidates had a close family relationship with the manager in charge of the evaluation. This fact was not officially disclosed, nor were measures taken to prevent potential bias in the decision, such as the involvement of an external evaluator or the talent department.